

Add the Notion-to-Canvas Builder to Claude

A step-by-step setup guide for MGCCC instructors (about 10 minutes)

What is this? A free add-on (a "skill") for the Claude app that builds your Canvas course for you: pages, weekly modules, assignments, and quizzes, all styled and ready.

Is it safe? Yes. It only builds **content**. It will **never** read or change student grades or submissions; that is blocked on purpose.

Before you start, you need:

- A **Windows PC**.
- **Claude Code** installed on it (the desktop app). The `claude.ai` **website will not work** for this. If you do not have it, ask IT or Zack.
- The file Zack sends you: **notion-to-canvas-skill.zip**.
- Your Canvas login (we will make an access "token" in Step 4).

Step 1 - Save and unzip the file

- Save **notion-to-canvas-skill.zip** to your **Desktop**.
- **Right-click** it, choose **Extract All...**, then click **Extract**.
- You now have a folder named **notion-to-canvas** (inside it: `SKILL.md`, plus references and scripts folders).

Step 2 - Put the skill where Claude looks for it

- Hold the **Windows key** and press **R**. A small "Run" box opens.
- Type this exactly and press Enter:

```
%USERPROFILE%\..\.claude\skills
```

- If a folder window opens: great, go to the next bullet.
- If Windows says it cannot find it: open File Explorer, go to This PC > C: > Users > (your name), and create the missing folders named **.claude** and then, inside it, **skills**. (Tip: to make a folder whose name starts with a dot, type **.claude.** with a dot on each end; Windows removes the last dot for you.)
- **Drag the notion-to-canvas folder** into that **skills** folder.

Check you did it right. You should now have this exact location (with your name instead of YOURNAME):

```
C:\Users\YOURNAME\.claude\skills\notion-to-canvas\SKILL.md
```

Step 3 - Restart Claude Code

- **Fully close** Claude Code and open it again (it loads skills when it starts).

- Test it: type this to Claude and press Enter:

Do you have the notion-to-canvas skill?

It should answer yes. If it does, the install worked.

Step 4 - Get your Canvas access token (one time)

- Log in to Canvas at **mgccc.instructure.com**.
- Click **Account** (left sidebar), then **Settings**.
- Scroll to **Approved Integrations**, then click **+ New Access Token**.
- For Purpose, type **Claude**. Leave the expiry blank (or set one). Click **Generate Token**.
- **Copy the long token now** and paste it into a temporary Notepad. You will not be able to see it again.

Treat this token like a password. Do not email it, post it, or paste it into a chat. Anyone who has it can act as you in Canvas.

Step 5 - Let Claude finish the setup for you

- Make a folder for your course work, for example **Documents\Canvas Build**.
- Open Claude Code in that folder.
- Type this to Claude (fill in your course number, the number in your course's web address):

Set up the notion-to-canvas skill for my Canvas course. My school is mgccc.instructure.com and my course number is _____. I will give you my access token.

- Follow Claude's steps. It creates the small settings files for you and saves your token in a private file (**canvas.token**) in that folder.
- Keep that folder private. Do not put it in a shared/synced location you do not control.

Step 6 - Use it (just ask in plain English)

- "Get my Notion course into Canvas."
- "Add a study guide page to Week 3."
- "Build a 25-point quiz from the Week 5 lesson."

Before it publishes anything, it will **ask** whether to make it visible to students or keep it hidden. When in doubt, choose **hidden**; you can publish later in Canvas.

Good to know

- **It builds:** pages, modules, assignments, discussions, quizzes, and the syllabus.
- **It will not** read or change student grades or submissions. That is intentional and cannot be turned on here.
- **Keep your canvas.token private.** If it ever leaks, delete it in Canvas (Step 4 screen) and make a new one.

If something goes wrong

- **"Claude does not see the skill."** Re-check the exact location in Step 2, then fully restart Claude Code.
- **"It cannot connect to Canvas."** Your token may be wrong or expired. Make a new one (Step 4).
- **"I do not have Claude Code."** This only works in the Claude Code desktop app, not the website. Ask IT.
- **Still stuck?** Contact Zack Garris.

MGCCC - Simulation & Game Design - notion-to-canvas skill - for instructor use. This tool never accesses student grades or submissions.